

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 7 5 4 2

♥ J 10 2

♦ Q 10 4 3

♣ 4

♠ A

♥ A 6 3

♦ K 5

♣ A K Q J 9 8 7

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 9 6 3

♥ Q 9 8 5

♦ 9

♣ 10 6 2

♠ J 8

♥ K 7 4

♦ A J 8 7 6 2

♣ 5 3

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	3♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♦
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♦
Pass	7♣		
All Pass			

7♣ by North
into a Threat card against West's ♦Q.

But, the ♠J is already a Threat card against East's ♠Q.

Play your ♣J and ♣9, discarding the ♦8 and the ♥4 from dummy.

East can afford to discard the ♠9 and the ♥5.

West can spare his two ♠s.

[showcards N:SJ,HK,H7,DJ E:HJ,HT,H2,DQ S:HA,H6,H3,C8 W:SQ,HQ,H9,H8]

You are there. Play your ♣8.

East cannot throw the ♠Q, so he gives up the ♥8. Dummy's ♠J is of no further value so you dump it.

West cannot throw the ♦Q, so he gives up the ♥2.

And you take the last three tricks with the ♥ suit. There were only two defenders; one of them had to guard ♠s and the other had to guard ♦s. There was nobody left to guard ♥s.

North is to play 7♣. East leads the ♠K.

At first glance this doesn't appear to be a difficult hand. You expect to win the opening lead, pull trumps, then establish a ♦ winner by playing ♦K, ♦A, and ruffing a ♦. As long as they split 3-2 you could reach dummy's ♦ winner with the ♥K.

So you take the ♠A, pull three rounds of trumps and play ♦K.

But when you lead to the ♦A East discards a small ♠.

Time to rethink. You are in dummy now, and you can ruff a ♦, return with the ♥K and ruff another ♦. The last ♦ would be good but you'd have no way to reach it.

Think squeeze instead. Ruff a ♦. This turns the ♦J

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K J 8 6 5 3 2		♠ 10 9 7
♥ 8 6 2		♥ 4
♦ 10		♦ Q J 9 4 2
♣ 7		♣ J 10 9 3
	♠ -	
	♥ A K Q 10 5	
	♦ A 8 6 3	
	♣ A K Q 4	

West	North	East	South
4♠	Pass	Pass	2♣
Pass	6♥		5♥
All Pass			

6♥ by South

either one is going to do the same thing. Assume West wins the ♦ 10.

He will then play the ♠ K, which you must ruff in your hand.

Now play a small ♦ to dummy's ♦ K.

[showcards N:HJ,D7,C8,C6 E:DQ,DJ,CJ,CT S:DA,D8,CQ,C4 W:SJ,S8,S6,S5]

You are in dummy, ready for the squeeze.

Play dummy's ♥ J.

East gets to choose his own fate - discarding a protector in one of the two suits. Of course, whichever suit he discards you will throw the opposite one.

Yet another slam, courtesy of the Squeeze Play!

South is to play 6♥. West leads the ♠ A.

If ♦s and ♣s split nicely this would be an easy slam. But with that wild ♠ bid by West you can't expect decent splits.

So you ruff the ♠, pull trumps in three rounds, then play ♣ A K and get the bad news when West discards a ♠.

You now know that East guards the ♣s. And since West had 3 ♥s and a very long ♠ suit it is pretty likely that East guards the ♦s also. You will try to squeeze East in ♣s and ♦s, but first you must lose a trick to rectify the count.

So you play a low ♦ from each hand.

It doesn't matter which defender takes the ♦, since